

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM (Comparative and International Dispute Resolution, Merit) graduate with direct international arbitration experience gained at BCLP, where I supported a complex investment arbitration from procedural submissions through to the Claimant's memorial. Experienced in legal research, document management, drafting procedural documents, maintaining structured case files and managing deadlines across competing matters. Currently advising clients on a range of civil matters at Citizens Advice, with continued engagement with arbitration through postgraduate study and professional events.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, procedural issues and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%
- Dissertation: development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration throughout: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, amended sections of the Claimant's memorial, and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Conducted legal research on substantive and procedural issues arising across the matter
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant filing deadline: coordinated outstanding document tasks, tracked actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and deadline tracking

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice, under qualified supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including issues around children's personal data and adtech
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed data-processing provisions and researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, procedural document drafting, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters